During the delay, Shevardnadze had explained to me the essence of Gorbachev's message: He wanted to meet me in London or Iceland the following month to see if the two of us could accelerate the arms control process before our meeting in Washington. Afterward, I wrote in my diary:

> I opted for Iceland. This would be preparatory to a Summit. I'm agreeable to that but made it plain we wanted Daniloff returned to us before anything took place. I let the F.M. know I was angry and that I resented their charges that Daniloff was a spy after I had personally given my word that he wasn't. I gave him a little run down on the difference between our two systems and told him they couldn't understand the importance we place on the individual because they don't have any such feeling.
>
> I enjoyed being angry.

Besides inviting me to an impromptu summit, Gorbachev's letter indicated he had little interest in the arms control initiative to which we had devoted so much effort in July. This is a portion of the letter:

> After we received your letter of July 25, 1986, which has been given careful consideration, certain developments and incidents of a negative nature have taken place. This is yet another indication of how sensitive relations between the USSR and the United States are and how important it is for the top leaders of the two countries to keep them constantly within view and exert a stabilizing influence whenever the amplitude of their fluctuations becomes threatening.
>
> Among such incidents—of the kind that have happened before and that, presumably, no one can be guaranteed against in the future—is the case of Zakharov and Daniloff. It requires a calm examination,